

ENTERING MANHOLES

- Check with 188A , wear hardhat, safety glasses and gloves(All items tested prior to use)
- Crack manhole using hookbar, placing end in and pry down, then lift up with legs, making sure your back is straight and knees are bent when pulling manhole cover off. In the winter you can hit manhole cover with a hammer or use a blower hose to thaw. The manhole cover is round so it will not fall in and cast iron so it won't spark.
- Place guardrail facing oncoming traffic, also place tub around hole and fill with air.
- If rainbow on water assume gasoline, no need to test if you smell:
To test; take inlet valve off, take cotton filter out and break the inhibitor filter and place into inlet valve. This inhibitor filter is good only for one shift , it protects the filament from lead.

WET HOLE: Take a reading 1' ft. above the water, 8 squeezes minimum.

DRY HOLE: Put Sampling hose at head level , 8 squeezes minimum

ALWAYS KEEP YOUR EYES ON THE NEEDLE IN METER IN CASE THE GAS BLOWS THE BALLAST CAUSING THE NEEDLE TO PIN TO THE RIGHT AND THEN GO BACK TO ZERO, LOOKING NORMAL.

If You Get A Gas Reading: Close manhole with cover, duct seal the 4 openings on the cover, notify test board, supervisor and the fire dept.

YOU NEVER PUMP WATER THAT HAS GASOLINE IN IT

If No Gas Reading Or Gasoline: Pump manhole, discharge hose goes downhill towards storm drain. **DO NOT PUMP INTO TRAFFIC.** After pumping , take another reading at head level.

No Reading: Purge manhole. Tag on chimney is a certain color that you would match to a color on the blower chart. If no tag ventilate a 15 minute minimum. When purging, blower hose has one 90 degree bend down into manhole. Hose is placed 1' ft. below chimney to 2' from bottom in manhole creating a mushroom effect blowing out hole.

Test Again With Meter, No Reading: Attach sampling hose to guard rail , be careful not kink. Other end goes into the manhole to provide a fresh air supply for purging.

- Strap EXPLOSIMETER on , enter manhole, facing traffic, use three point contact on ladder.
- Power Ventilate by bending hose an additional 90 degrees. Bend at top underside of manhole close to ceiling and towards an end wall.
- Test cracks, ducts, corners - Top and bottom, ducts that are open or are being opened.
- A gas reading indicates gas in the duct, plug duct with duct seal after blowing duct with blower
- No reading is safe, if you cannot control reading with blower, EXIT MANHOLE, notify
- If you got an initial reading of explosive gas, before you entered manhole test again, **if over 10% do not go in**, call your supervisor. If green - OK.
- Under normal conditions w/o tent, re-test every 2 hours if no initial reading, at shift changes , after breaks , lunch and **before you light a torch.** If initial reading retest every hour.
- If using a tent, cut the 2 hours in half and test every hour. If you got an initial reading and are using a tent, cut the times in half again and test every ½ hour.

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